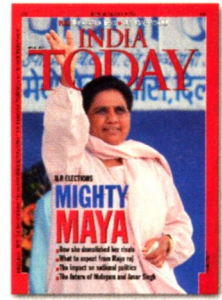


(SHAN TANKHA)



"Maya's Magic",
May 21, 2007

"Mayawati has triumphed without the support of the media. This has made her the second most powerful woman in the world of Indian politics."

S.D. KUMAR, on e-mail

The Winning Formula

True to what her name stands for, Mayawati has pulled out a magic of sorts in Uttar Pradesh ("Maya's Magic", May 21). It now remains to be seen if her enchantment stays for a full tenure and the country gets good governance.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

It's ironic that people have voted for Mayawati, the same woman who was involved in the Taj Corridor scam. With the formation of the new government in Uttar Pradesh, 22 ministers with criminal records will now take oath in the Assembly. That is not synonymous with development.

HIRAK K. SENGUPTA, Delhi

Mayawati has made an indelible impact as the shrewdest political operator and her gamble has paid off handsomely.

Her social engineering has proved to be a new political idiom and being the pioneer, she is bound to use it to her advantage in the general elections of 2009.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

BSP's strategy of wooing Brahmins in the state alone made the difference between a hung Assembly and a single-party majority. And by announcing reservation for the backward among the upper castes and other religious communities, Mayawati has played a master stroke.

MEGHA A., Hyderabad

Politics should not be given much importance in India. Be it Mayawati or Mulayam Singh Yadav, the state of affairs in Uttar Pradesh will not change. It seems as if leaders are only interested in personal gains while playing politics.

TRISHEET CHATTERJEE,
on e-mail

The victory of Mayawati in Uttar Pradesh was much required to keep frauds like Amitabh Bachchan away from politics. Political parties should realise that Bollywood is different and its charm can't work in politics.

S. BALAKRISHNAN, Jamshedpur

The Samajwadi Party roped in the Bachchans, the Congress banked on Rahul Gandhi. But it was BSP which finally won. This shows that people vote for those whose promises seem convincing. Mayawati should bear in mind that her new voters have lent their mandate with the hope that she would deliver in the next five years. Now, it's her turn to act.

RANJANA MANCHANDA,
Bangalore

The resounding victory of Mayawati in Uttar Pradesh elections has come as a pleasant surprise to most people. This is because she

displayed vision and promised to cater to all castes, which is vital in a pluralistic society and a polity like ours.

R.D. SINGH, Jammu

The BSP supremo has a very valuable lesson for national political parties—India is ready for agenda-based politics rather than just caste considerations.

UMA TRILOK, Delhi

The exit polls which predicted a hopelessly hung Assembly have failed to deliver yet again. It shows how far they are from ground reality. This also applies to political parties which underestimated BSP's potential.

D.B.N. MURTHY, on e-mail

Trigger Happy

Sohrabuddin Sheikh's death in a fake encounter should evoke no sympathy ("Killer Thriller", May 21). After all, he was on the 'wanted' list. The duty of